

# LA(1)LR(0)

임기정

## Abstract

This note fixes the LR(0) characteristic automaton, defines the one-symbol lookahead set attached to each completed LR(0) item, and derives the usual Read/Follow digraph computation. The proofs are written so that the essential claims appear as inclusions, fixed-point equations, and derivation chains.

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# 1 The LR(0) Automaton

**Definition 1** ( $\text{LRA}(G)$ ). Let  $G \triangleq (N, T, P, S)$  be a context-free grammar. Define:

- (i)  $G' = (N', T', P', S') \triangleq (N \uplus \{S'\}, T \uplus \{\$, \}, P \cup \{[S' \rightarrow S\$]\}, S')$ .
- (ii)  $V \triangleq N \uplus T, \quad V' \triangleq N' \uplus T'.$
- (iii)  $\beta \xRightarrow{\text{rm}}_{P'} \gamma \iff^{\text{def}} (\beta, \gamma) \in \{(\alpha Az, \alpha \omega z) \mid [A \rightarrow \omega] \in P', \alpha \in V'^*, z \in T'^*\}.$
- (iv)  $I_{\text{LR}(0)} \triangleq \{[A \rightarrow \alpha \cdot \beta] \mid [A \rightarrow \alpha\beta] \in P'\}.$
- (v) For  $q \subseteq I_{\text{LR}(0)}$ ,  
 $\text{Cl}(q) =_{\mu} q \cup \{[A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega] \mid [A \rightarrow \omega] \in P', [B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in \text{Cl}(q)\}.$
- (vi)  $q_0 \triangleq \text{Cl}(\{[S' \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot S\$]\}).$
- (vii) For  $q \subseteq I_{\text{LR}(0)}$  and  $X \in V'$ ,  
 $\text{GOTO}(q, X) \triangleq \text{Cl}(\{[A \rightarrow \alpha X \cdot \beta] \mid [A \rightarrow \alpha \cdot X\beta] \in q\}).$
- (viii)  $Q \triangleq \text{PT} \setminus \{\emptyset\}, \quad \text{PT} =_{\mu} \{q_0\} \cup \{\text{GOTO}(q, X) \mid q \in \text{PT}, X \in V'\}.$
- (ix) The path relation is the least relation satisfying  
 $\varepsilon : p \rightarrow q \iff p \in Q \wedge p = q, \quad X\alpha : p \rightarrow q \iff p \in Q \wedge \alpha : \text{GOTO}(p, X) \rightarrow q.$
- (x)  $\mathbf{Config} \triangleq \{(\alpha : p \rightarrow q, z) \mid \alpha \in V'^*, p, q \in Q, z \in T'^*, \alpha : p \rightarrow q\}.$
- (xi)  $\delta(q, X) \triangleq \text{GOTO}(q, X) \quad (q \in Q, X \in V').$
- (xii)  $\mathbf{reduce}(q, t) \triangleq \{[A \rightarrow \omega] \mid [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q\} \quad (q \in Q, t \in T').$
- (xiii) Let  $\vdash \subseteq \mathbf{Config} \times \mathbf{Config}$  be generated by:
$$\frac{q'' = \delta(q', t)}{(\alpha : q \rightarrow q', tz) \vdash (\alpha t : q \rightarrow q'', z)} \text{ Shift}$$

$$\frac{\alpha : q \rightarrow p \quad \omega : p \rightarrow q' \quad [A \rightarrow \omega] \in \mathbf{reduce}(q', t) \quad q'' = \delta(p, A)}{(\alpha \omega : q \rightarrow q', tz) \vdash (\alpha A : q \rightarrow q'', tz)} \text{ Reduce}(A \rightarrow \omega)$$
- (xiv)  $q_f \triangleq \delta(\delta(q_0, S), \$).$
- (xv) The accepted language is

$$L(\text{LRA}(G)) \triangleq \{z \in T^* \mid (\varepsilon : q_0 \rightarrow q_0, z\$) \vdash^* (S\$ : q_0 \rightarrow q_f, \varepsilon)\}.$$

**Fact 2** (Elimination of non-productive nonterminals). Call  $A \in N'$  *productive* if  $A \Rightarrow_{P'}^* w$  for some  $w \in T'^*$ , and *non-productive* otherwise. Removing every non-productive nonterminal together with all productions that mention one preserves the generated language. Hence, whenever  $L(G) \neq \emptyset$ , we may assume without loss of generality that every nonterminal of  $G'$  is productive; when  $L(G) = \emptyset$  the identity  $L(\text{LRA}(G)) = L(G) = \emptyset$  already follows from soundness (Corollary 6).

*Proof.* Extend productivity to strings:  $\sigma \in V'^*$  is productive if  $\sigma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* x$  for some  $x \in T'^*$ . A terminal derives only itself and a derivation of a string is the concatenation of derivations of its symbols, so

$$Y_1 \cdots Y_m \text{ productive} \iff \forall i. Y_i \text{ productive} \quad (t \in T' \text{ productive}). \quad (1)$$

FIXED-POINT CHARACTERIZATION. Let  $\text{Gen} \subseteq N'$  be the least fixed point

$$\text{Gen} = \bigcup_{n \geq 0} \text{Gen}_n, \quad \text{Gen}_0 = \emptyset, \quad \text{Gen}_{n+1} = \{A \in N' \mid \exists [A \rightarrow X_1 \cdots X_k] \in P'. \forall i. X_i \in T' \cup \text{Gen}_n\}$$

(with  $k = 0$ , i.e.  $[A \rightarrow \varepsilon] \in P'$ , permitted). Then  $A$  is productive iff  $A \in \text{Gen}$ :

$$\begin{aligned} A \in \text{Gen}_{n+1} &\implies [A \rightarrow X_1 \cdots X_k] \in P' \text{ with } X_i \in T' \cup \text{Gen}_n \\ &\xRightarrow{\text{IH}_g} A \Rightarrow_{P'} X_1 \cdots X_k \Rightarrow_{P'}^* x_1 \cdots x_k \in T'^*; \\ A \Rightarrow_{P'}^\ell w \in T'^* \ (\ell \geq 1) &\implies A \Rightarrow_{P'} X_1 \cdots X_k \Rightarrow_{P'}^{\ell-1} w, \ X_i \Rightarrow_{P'}^{\ell_i} w_i, \ \ell_i < \ell \\ &\xRightarrow{\text{IH}_\ell} X_i \in T' \cup \text{Gen} \implies A \in \text{Gen}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus the non-productive nonterminals are exactly  $N' \setminus \text{Gen}$ , a least fixed point.

LANGUAGE PRESERVATION. Let  $\widehat{G}$  delete  $N' \setminus \text{Gen}$  and every production mentioning it; since terminals are productive, its productions are

$$\widehat{P} \triangleq \{[A \rightarrow X_1 \cdots X_k] \in P' \mid A, X_1, \dots, X_k \text{ all productive}\} \subseteq P'.$$

As  $\widehat{P} \subseteq P'$ ,  $S' \Rightarrow_{\widehat{P}}^* z$  implies  $S' \Rightarrow_{P'}^* z$ . For the converse, induct on the length  $\ell$  of  $\sigma \Rightarrow_{P'}^\ell x \in T'^*$ :

$$\sigma \Rightarrow_{P'}^\ell x \in T'^* \implies \sigma \text{ productive} \wedge \sigma \Rightarrow_{\widehat{P}}^* x.$$

For  $\ell = 0$ ,  $\sigma = x \in T'^*$ . For  $\ell \geq 1$ , split off the first step  $\sigma = \sigma_1 C \sigma_2$ ,  $[C \rightarrow \gamma] \in P'$ ,  $\sigma_1, \sigma_2 \in V'^*$ :

$$\sigma = \sigma_1 C \sigma_2 \Rightarrow_{P'} \sigma_1 \gamma \sigma_2 \Rightarrow_{P'}^{\ell-1} x \xRightarrow{\text{IH}} \sigma_1 \gamma \sigma_2 \text{ productive} \wedge \sigma_1 \gamma \sigma_2 \Rightarrow_{\widehat{P}}^* x.$$

By (1),  $\gamma$  is productive, hence so is  $C$  (via  $[C \rightarrow \gamma]$ ), so  $[C \rightarrow \gamma] \in \widehat{P}$  and

$$\sigma = \sigma_1 C \sigma_2 \Rightarrow_{\widehat{P}} \sigma_1 \gamma \sigma_2 \Rightarrow_{\widehat{P}}^* x.$$

Taking  $\sigma = S'$  gives  $L(G') \subseteq L(\widehat{G})$ , so  $L(\widehat{G}) = L(G')$  and every nonterminal of  $\widehat{G}$  is productive.

When  $L(G) \neq \emptyset$ ,  $S$  is productive, hence  $S'$  is productive ( $[S' \rightarrow S\$]$ ) and  $\widehat{G}$  keeps the start symbol with the same language; replacing  $G'$  by  $\widehat{G}$  loses no generality. When  $L(G) = \emptyset$ ,  $S \notin \text{Gen}$  and Corollary 6 gives  $L(\text{LRA}(G)) \subseteq L(G) = \emptyset$  directly.  $\square$

For  $c = (\alpha : p \rightarrow q, u) \in \mathbf{Config}$ , put

$$Y(c) \triangleq \alpha u \in V'^*.$$

The path relation factors through the state reached after any prefix: induction on  $|\alpha|$  using Definition 1(ix) gives, for all  $\alpha, \omega \in V'^*$  and  $r \in Q$ ,

$$\alpha \omega : r \rightarrow q \iff \exists! p \in Q. \alpha : r \rightarrow p \wedge \omega : p \rightarrow q, \quad (2)$$

the intermediate state being  $p = \delta(\cdots \delta(\delta(r, \alpha_1), \alpha_2) \cdots, \alpha_{|\alpha|})$  since each  $\delta(\cdot, X) = \text{GOTO}(\cdot, X)$  is single-valued.

**Lemma 3** (LR(0) path invariants). *For  $\eta \in V'^*$ , the characteristic automaton satisfies*

$$(\exists q \in Q) \ \eta : q_0 \rightarrow q \iff \eta \text{ is a viable prefix of } G', \quad (3)$$

$$\left. \begin{aligned} \eta &= \eta' \omega, \quad \eta' : q_0 \rightarrow p, \quad \omega : p \rightarrow q, \\ S' &\xRightarrow{\text{rm}_{P'}}^* \eta' A y \xRightarrow{\text{rm}_{P'}} \eta' \omega y, \quad y = tz \in T'^* \end{aligned} \right\} \implies [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q \wedge [A \rightarrow \omega] \in \mathbf{reduce}(q, t). \quad (4)$$

*Proof.* By Fact 2 we may assume every nonterminal of  $G'$  is productive:  $C \Rightarrow_{P'}^* x$  for some  $x \in T'^*$ . Write  $\sqsubseteq$  for the prefix order on  $V'^*$ . Call an item *valid* for  $\eta \in V'^*$  when

$$[A \rightarrow \alpha \cdot \beta] \in \text{Valid}(\eta) \stackrel{\text{def}}{\iff} \exists \delta \in V'^*, w \in T'^*. \eta = \delta\alpha \wedge S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta Aw \quad (5)$$

(then  $[A \rightarrow \alpha\beta] \in P'$  and  $w \in T'^*$  make  $\delta Aw \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta\alpha\beta w$  a rightmost step). Validity captures viability:

$$\text{Valid}(\eta) \neq \emptyset \iff \eta \text{ is a viable prefix of } G', \quad (6)$$

since  $[A \rightarrow \alpha \cdot \beta] \in \text{Valid}(\eta)$  yields  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta Aw \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta\alpha\beta w$  with  $\eta = \delta\alpha \sqsubseteq \delta\alpha\beta$ , while a viable prefix  $\eta \sqsubseteq \delta\alpha\beta$  (from  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta Aw \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta\alpha\beta w$ ) factors as  $\eta = \delta\alpha\beta_1$ ,  $\beta = \beta_1\beta_2$ , giving  $[A \rightarrow \alpha\beta_1 \cdot \beta_2] \in \text{Valid}(\eta)$ .

CLOSURE COMPUTES THE VALID ITEMS AT A FIXED  $\eta$ . If  $q \subseteq \text{Valid}(\eta)$  contains every valid item with nonempty left part (and the seed  $[S' \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot S\$]$  when  $\eta = \varepsilon$ ), then  $\text{Cl}(q) = \text{Valid}(\eta)$ . For  $\subseteq$ , the closure rule adds  $[A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega]$  only from some  $[B \rightarrow \beta_1 \cdot A\beta_2] \in \text{Cl}(q) \subseteq \text{Valid}(\eta)$ , and productivity  $\beta_2 \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} x \in T'^*$  gives

$$S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta Bw \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta\beta_1 A\beta_2 w \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \delta\beta_1 A x w, \quad \eta = \delta\beta_1, \quad xw \in T'^* \implies [A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega] \in \text{Valid}(\eta).$$

For  $\supseteq$ , take  $[A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega] \in \text{Valid}(\eta)$  with a witness  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \eta Aw$  and induct on its length. Length 0 forces  $\eta Aw = S'$ , i.e.  $\eta = \varepsilon$ ,  $A = S'$ , the seed. Otherwise the step first introducing this occurrence of  $A$  reads

$$S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \mu C\rho \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \mu\sigma_1 A\sigma_2\rho, \quad [C \rightarrow \sigma_1 A\sigma_2] \in P', \quad \eta = \mu\sigma_1, \quad \rho \in T'^*,$$

so  $[C \rightarrow \sigma_1 \cdot A\sigma_2] \in \text{Valid}(\eta)$  by the shorter witness  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \mu C\rho$ . This item lies in  $q$  (if  $\sigma_1 \neq \varepsilon$ ) or in  $\text{Cl}(q)$  (induction hypothesis, if  $\sigma_1 = \varepsilon$ ); its dot precedes  $A$ , so the closure rule appends  $[A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega] \in \text{Cl}(q)$ .

GOTO SHIFTS THE PREFIX. By (5), for every  $X \in V'$ ,

$$[A \rightarrow \alpha \cdot X\beta] \in \text{Valid}(\eta) \iff [A \rightarrow \alpha X \cdot \beta] \in \text{Valid}(\eta X) \quad (\text{same } \delta, w; \eta = \delta\alpha \iff \eta X = \delta\alpha X),$$

and every nonempty-left-part valid item for  $\eta X$  ends in  $X$ , hence has this form. These items are the GOTO-kernel; closing it gives

$$q = \text{Valid}(\eta) \implies \text{GOTO}(q, X) = \text{Valid}(\eta X). \quad (7)$$

INDUCTION ON  $|\eta|$ . No valid item for  $\varepsilon$  has a nonempty left part, so  $q_0 = \text{Cl}(\{[S' \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot S\$]\}) = \text{Valid}(\varepsilon)$ . Inductively,  $\eta X : q_0 \rightarrow q'$  means  $\eta : q_0 \rightarrow q$  with  $q = \text{Valid}(\eta)$  and  $q' = \delta(q, X) = \text{GOTO}(q, X) \stackrel{(7)}{=} \text{Valid}(\eta X)$ . Hence

$$\eta : q_0 \rightarrow q \implies q = \text{Valid}(\eta). \quad (8)$$

Because every state on a path lies in  $Q = \text{PT} \setminus \{\emptyset\}$ , and prefixes of a viable prefix are viable (so a run never blocks),

$$(\exists q \in Q) \eta : q_0 \rightarrow q \stackrel{(8)}{\iff} \text{Valid}(\eta) \neq \emptyset \stackrel{(6)}{\iff} \eta \text{ is a viable prefix of } G',$$

which is (3).

HANDLE INVARIANT. With  $\eta = \eta'\omega$ ,  $\eta' : q_0 \rightarrow p$ ,  $\omega : p \rightarrow q$ , and  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \eta' Ay \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \eta'\omega y$ ,  $y = tz \in T'^*$ : (2) gives  $\eta'\omega : q_0 \rightarrow q$ , so  $q = \text{Valid}(\eta'\omega)$  by (8). Taking  $\delta = \eta'$ ,  $w = y$  in (5),

$$S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \eta' Ay, \quad y \in T'^* \implies [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in \text{Valid}(\eta'\omega) = q \stackrel{\text{Def. 1(xii)}}{\implies} [A \rightarrow \omega] \in \text{reduce}(q, t),$$

which is (4). □

**Lemma 4** (One-step yield invariant). *Each parser step reverses zero or one rightmost grammar step:*

$$c \vdash c' \implies \begin{cases} Y(c') = Y(c), & \text{if the step is Shift,} \\ Y(c') \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} Y(c), & \text{if the step is Reduce.} \end{cases} \quad (9)$$

*Proof.* Indeed,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Shift : } & Y(\alpha : q \rightarrow q', tz) = \alpha tz = Y(\alpha t : q \rightarrow q'', z), \\ \text{Reduce : } & Y(\alpha A : q \rightarrow q'', tz) = \alpha A t z \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha \omega t z = Y(\alpha \omega : q \rightarrow q', tz). \end{aligned}$$

□

**Corollary 5** (Multi-step yield invariant). *For  $c, c' \in \mathbf{Config}$ ,*

$$c \vdash^* c' \implies Y(c') \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} Y(c). \quad (10)$$

*Proof.* Induct on the length of  $c \vdash^* c'$  and use Lemma 4 at each parser step.  $\square$

**Corollary 6** (LR(0) soundness).

$$L(\mathbf{LRA}(G)) \subseteq L(G).$$

*Proof.*

$$\begin{aligned} z \in L(\mathbf{LRA}(G)) &\implies (\varepsilon : q_0 \rightarrow q_0, z\$) \vdash^* (S\$ : q_0 \rightarrow q_f, \varepsilon) \\ &\xRightarrow{(10)} S\$ \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} z\$ \\ &\implies S \Rightarrow_P^* z \\ &\implies z \in L(G). \end{aligned}$$

The third implication deletes the endmarker. Write the rightmost derivation witnessing  $S\$ \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} z\$$  as

$$S\$ = \gamma_0 \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \gamma_1 \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \cdots \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \gamma_M = z\$.$$

Since  $S'$  occurs on no right-hand side of  $P'$ , the only production mentioning  $S'$ , namely  $[S' \rightarrow S\$]$ , is never applicable to a form derived from  $S\$$ ; hence every step uses a production of  $P \subseteq P'$ . Moreover  $\$ \notin V$  occurs on no right-hand side of  $P$ , and no production of  $P$  rewrites a terminal, so the rightmost symbol  $\$$  of  $\gamma_0$  is never touched:

$$\gamma_k = \delta_k \$, \quad \delta_k \in V^* \quad (0 \leq k \leq M), \quad \delta_0 = S, \quad \delta_M = z, \quad \delta_k \Rightarrow_P \delta_{k+1}.$$

Stripping the common trailing  $\$$  therefore yields  $S = \delta_0 \Rightarrow_P \delta_1 \Rightarrow_P \cdots \Rightarrow_P \delta_M = z$ , i.e.  $S \Rightarrow_P^* z$ .  $\square$

**Lemma 7** (LR(0) completeness).

$$L(G) \subseteq L(\mathbf{LRA}(G)).$$

*Proof.* Let  $z \in L(G)$ , so  $S \Rightarrow_P^* z$ . Choose a rightmost derivation in  $G'$ :

$$S\$ = \gamma_0 \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \gamma_1 \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \cdots \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \gamma_N = z\$. \quad (11)$$

Write its  $k$ -th step as

$$\gamma_k = \alpha_k A_k y_k \xRightarrow[\mathbf{rm}_{P'}]{*} \alpha_k \omega_k y_k = \gamma_{k+1}, \quad [A_k \rightarrow \omega_k] \in P', \quad y_k = t_k z_k \in T'^*. \quad (12)$$

By (4), for each  $k$  there exist  $p_k, q_k \in Q$  such that

$$\alpha_k : q_0 \rightarrow p_k, \quad \omega_k : p_k \rightarrow q_k, \quad [A_k \rightarrow \omega_k \cdot \varepsilon] \in q_k, \quad [A_k \rightarrow \omega_k] \in \mathbf{reduce}(q_k, t_k). \quad (13)$$

Reading (11) from right to left turns each step into one inverse reduction. By (13) and (2),  $\alpha_k \omega_k : q_0 \rightarrow q_k$ , so the  $\mathbf{Reduce}(A_k \rightarrow \omega_k)$  rule applies:

$$(\alpha_k \omega_k : q_0 \rightarrow q_k, y_k) \vdash (\alpha_k A_k : q_0 \rightarrow \delta(p_k, A_k), y_k) \quad (k = N-1, \dots, 0). \quad (14)$$

These reductions are interleaved with Shift blocks. Since  $y_k \in T'^*$ , the symbol  $A_k$  exposed at step  $k$  is the rightmost nonterminal of  $\gamma_k = \alpha_k A_k y_k$ ; using the previous step  $\gamma_k = \alpha_{k-1} \omega_{k-1} y_{k-1}$  with  $y_{k-1} \in T'^*$  and cancelling the common terminal suffix,

$$\alpha_k A_k u_k = \alpha_{k-1} \omega_{k-1}, \quad y_k = u_k y_{k-1}, \quad u_k \in T'^* \quad (1 \leq k \leq N-1). \quad (15)$$

By (2) the path  $\alpha_{k-1} \omega_{k-1} : q_0 \rightarrow q_{k-1}$  factors through  $\delta(p_k, A_k)$  after the prefix  $\alpha_k A_k$ , so the  $|u_k|$  symbols of  $u_k$  are shifted one by one:

$$(\alpha_k A_k : q_0 \rightarrow \delta(p_k, A_k), u_k y_{k-1}) \vdash^{|u_k|} (\alpha_{k-1} \omega_{k-1} : q_0 \rightarrow q_{k-1}, y_{k-1}).$$

At the bottom ( $k = N-1$ ), the run starts by shifting all of  $\alpha_{N-1} \omega_{N-1}$  out of  $z\$ = \gamma_N$ :

$$(\varepsilon : q_0 \rightarrow q_0, z\$) \vdash^{|\alpha_{N-1} \omega_{N-1}|} (\alpha_{N-1} \omega_{N-1} : q_0 \rightarrow q_{N-1}, y_{N-1}).$$

At the top ( $k = 0$ ) we have  $\gamma_0 = S\$$ , whence  $\alpha_0 = \varepsilon$ ,  $A_0 = S$ ,  $y_0 = \$$ ; (14) leaves the stack  $S$  reading  $\$$ , and one final Shift of  $\$$  gives

$$(S : q_0 \rightarrow \delta(q_0, S), \$) \vdash (S\$ : q_0 \rightarrow q_f, \varepsilon), \quad q_f = \delta(\delta(q_0, S), \$).$$

Concatenating the Shift blocks with (14) for  $k = N - 1, \dots, 0$  gives

$$(\varepsilon : q_0 \rightarrow q_0, z\$) \vdash^* (S\$ : q_0 \rightarrow q_f, \varepsilon),$$

hence  $z \in L(\text{LRA}(G))$ . □

**Corollary 8** (Correctness of  $\text{LRA}(G)$ ).

$$L(G) = L(\text{LRA}(G)), \quad L(G) \triangleq \{z \in T^* \mid S \Rightarrow_P^* z\}.$$

*Proof.* Corollary 6 and Lemma 7 give

$$L(\text{LRA}(G)) \subseteq L(G), \quad L(G) \subseteq L(\text{LRA}(G)).$$

□

## 2 Read and Follow Sets

Define

$$\mathbf{LA} : \{(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) \mid q \in Q, [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q\} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(T')$$

by

$$\mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) \triangleq \left\{ t \in T' \mid S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm}_{P'}]{*} \alpha Atz, \alpha \omega : q_0 \rightarrow q, \alpha \in V'^*, z \in T'^* \right\}. \quad (16)$$

The remainder of this section computes  $\mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega])$  from the  $\text{LR}(0)$  automaton, as the least fixed point of a Read/Follow digraph.

Let

$$D \triangleq \{(p, A) \mid p \in Q, A \in N', \delta(p, A) \neq \emptyset\}.$$

For a relation  $R$ , write

$$R!x \triangleq \{y \mid (x, y) \in R\}.$$

Define **Read**, **Follow**  $\subseteq D \times T'$  as the least relations generated by the rules

$$\begin{array}{c} \frac{\delta(\delta(p, A), t) \neq \emptyset}{t \in \mathbf{Read}!(p, A)} \text{DR} \qquad \frac{\delta(p, A) = r \quad C \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \quad (r, C) \in D}{\mathbf{Read}!(r, C) \subseteq \mathbf{Read}!(p, A)} \text{reads} \\[10pt] \frac{t \in \mathbf{Read}!(p, A)}{t \in \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A)} \text{Read} \quad \frac{[B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in p \quad \beta : p' \rightarrow p \quad \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \quad (p', B) \in D}{\mathbf{Follow}!(p', B) \subseteq \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A)} \text{includes} \end{array}$$

Define the semantic read and follow sets on  $D$ :

$$\text{Read}(p, A) \triangleq \{t \in T' \mid \exists r, s, \gamma. r = \delta(p, A) \wedge \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \wedge \gamma t : r \rightarrow s\}, \quad (17)$$

$$\text{Follow}(p, A) \triangleq \left\{ t \in T' \mid \exists \alpha, z. S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm}_{P'}]{*} \alpha Atz \wedge \alpha : q_0 \rightarrow p \wedge z \in T'^* \right\}. \quad (18)$$

For  $(p, A) \in D$ , set

$$\text{DR}(p, A) \triangleq \{t \in T' \mid \delta(\delta(p, A), t) \neq \emptyset\}.$$

Let

$$\Phi_R(F)(p, A) = \text{DR}(p, A) \cup \bigcup_{\substack{\delta(p, A) = r \\ C \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \\ (r, C) \in D}} F(r, C).$$

**Lemma 9** (Semantic Read fixed point). *For  $(p, A) \in D$ ,*

$$\mathbf{Read}!(p, A) = \mu \Phi_R(p, A) = \text{Read}(p, A). \quad (19)$$

*Proof.* The two **Read**-rules say exactly that **Read!** is the least  $\Phi_R$ -closed family, i.e.  $\mathbf{Read!}(p, A) = \mu\Phi_R(p, A)$ ; since  $\Phi_R$  is monotone on the finite lattice  $D \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(T')$ ,

$$\mu\Phi_R = \bigcup_{m \geq 0} \Phi_R^m(\emptyset).$$

Write  $(p, A) \rightsquigarrow_R (r, C)$  for the reads edge  $r = \delta(p, A) \wedge C \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \wedge (r, C) \in D$ . Because  $\Phi_R(\emptyset)(p, A) = \text{DR}(p, A)$ , an induction on  $m$  unfolds the operator into reads-paths:

$$\Phi_R^{m+1}(\emptyset)(p, A) = \bigcup_{i=0}^m \bigcup_{(p, A) \rightsquigarrow_R^i (r, C)} \text{DR}(r, C). \quad (20)$$

By (17),  $t \in \text{Read}(p, A)$  iff for some nullable  $\gamma = C_1 \cdots C_n \in N'^*$ ,

$$r_0 = \delta(p, A), \quad r_i = \delta(r_{i-1}, C_i) \ (1 \leq i \leq n), \quad \delta(r_n, t) \neq \emptyset,$$

which is precisely an  $n$ -edge reads-path ending at a DR-seed holding  $t$ :

$$(p, A) \rightsquigarrow_R (r_0, C_1) \rightsquigarrow_R \cdots \rightsquigarrow_R (r_{n-1}, C_n), \quad t \in \text{DR}(r_{n-1}, C_n) \quad (\delta(\delta(r_{n-1}, C_n), t) = \delta(r_n, t) \neq \emptyset).$$

By (20) this is equivalent to  $t \in \Phi_R^{n+1}(\emptyset)(p, A) \subseteq \mu\Phi_R(p, A)$ , and conversely each member of the union (20) reads back as such a nullable  $\delta$ -chain. Hence (19).  $\square$

Let

$$\Phi_F(F)(p, A) = \text{Read}(p, A) \cup \bigcup_{\substack{[B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in p \\ \beta : p' \rightarrow p \\ \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \\ (p', B) \in D}} F(p', B).$$

**Lemma 10** (Semantic Follow fixed point). *For  $(p, A) \in D$ ,*

$$\mathbf{Follow!}(p, A) = \mu\Phi_F(p, A) = \mathbf{Follow}(p, A). \quad (21)$$

*Proof.* By Lemma 9, the two **Follow**-rules define the least fixed point of  $\Phi_F$ . First Follow is closed under  $\Phi_F$ . For the Read-seed, fix  $t \in \text{Read}(p, A)$ . As  $p \in Q$  is reachable from  $q_0$  by construction of PT, pick  $\alpha$  with  $\alpha : q_0 \rightarrow p$ ; by (17) there is a nullable  $\gamma$  with  $\gamma t : \delta(p, A) \rightarrow s$ , so (2) yields  $\alpha A\gamma t : q_0 \rightarrow s$ , and (3) makes  $\alpha A\gamma t$  a viable prefix, i.e.  $S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A\gamma t z$  for some  $z \in T'^*$ . Hence

$$\begin{aligned} t \in \text{Read}(p, A) &\implies \exists \alpha, \gamma, z. \alpha : q_0 \rightarrow p \wedge \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \wedge S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A\gamma t z \\ &\implies S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A\gamma t z \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A t z \quad (\gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon \text{ rewritten rightmost}) \\ &\implies t \in \mathbf{Follow}(p, A). \end{aligned}$$

For an includes edge,

$$\begin{aligned} t \in \mathbf{Follow}(p', B), \quad [B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in p, \quad \beta : p' \rightarrow p, \quad \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon &\implies S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha' B t z \\ &\xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha' \beta A \gamma t z \\ &\xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha' \beta A t z, \end{aligned}$$

with  $\alpha' \beta : q_0 \rightarrow p$ ; hence

$$\mathbf{Follow}(p', B) \subseteq \mathbf{Follow}(p, A).$$

Conversely, let  $t \in \mathbf{Follow}(p, A)$ , witnessed by

$$S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A t z, \quad \alpha : q_0 \rightarrow p.$$

The production  $B \rightarrow \beta A\gamma$  that created this occurrence of  $A$  gives a factorization

$$S' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha' B t' z' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha' \beta A \gamma t' z' \xRightarrow[\text{rm } P']{*} \alpha A t z, \quad \alpha = \alpha' \beta, \quad t' z' \in T'^*,$$

in which the last segment rewrites only the suffix,  $\gamma t' z' \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* tz$ , leaving this  $A$  untouched. Splitting on whether  $\gamma$  is nullable makes exactly one alternative hold:

$$\begin{cases} \gamma = \gamma_0 X \gamma_1, & \gamma_0 \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon, & X \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* t\chi, & t \in \text{Read}(p, A), \\ \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon, & t = t', & & t \in \text{Follow}(p', B) \text{ and } (p, A) \rightsquigarrow_{\text{includes}} (p', B). \end{cases}$$

In the first case  $\gamma_0$  is read off  $\delta(p, A)$  by a nullable  $\delta$ -chain and  $t \in \text{FIRST}(X)$  gives  $\delta(\cdot, t) \neq \emptyset$ , so  $\gamma_0 t : \delta(p, A) \rightarrow s$  realizes (17). In the second,  $\gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon$  forces  $t = t'$ , and

$$S' \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* \alpha' Btz, \quad \alpha' : q_0 \rightarrow p' \text{ ((2) on } \alpha = \alpha' \beta) \implies t \in \text{Follow}(p', B),$$

the includes edge holding by  $[B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in p, \beta : p' \rightarrow p, \gamma \Rightarrow_{P'}^* \varepsilon$ . Its witnessing derivation  $S' \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* \alpha' Btz$  is strictly shorter, so induction on the length gives

$$\text{Follow}(p, A) \subseteq \mu\Phi_F(p, A).$$

Together with closure, this proves (21). □

**Corollary 11** (Lookahead by Follow). *Whenever  $q \in Q$  and  $[A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q$ ,*

$$\mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) = \{t \in T' \mid \exists p \in Q. \omega : p \rightarrow q \wedge \delta(p, A) \neq \emptyset \wedge t \in \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A)\}. \quad (22)$$

*Proof.* For  $q \in Q$  and  $[A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q$ ,

$$\begin{aligned} t \in \mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) &\iff \exists \alpha, z. S' \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* \alpha Atz \wedge \alpha \omega : q_0 \rightarrow q \\ &\stackrel{(2)}{\iff} \exists p, \alpha, z. S' \xRightarrow{\text{rm } P'}^* \alpha Atz \wedge \alpha : q_0 \rightarrow p \wedge \omega : p \rightarrow q \\ &\stackrel{(18)}{\iff} \exists p. \omega : p \rightarrow q \wedge \delta(p, A) \neq \emptyset \wedge t \in \mathbf{Follow}(p, A) \\ &\stackrel{(21)}{\iff} \exists p. \omega : p \rightarrow q \wedge \delta(p, A) \neq \emptyset \wedge t \in \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A). \end{aligned}$$

The side condition  $\delta(p, A) \neq \emptyset$  is automatic for  $A \neq S'$ : tracing  $[A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q$  backward along  $\omega : p \rightarrow q$  gives  $[A \rightarrow \varepsilon \cdot \omega] \in p$ , which is introduced by an item with the dot before  $A$ . For  $A = S'$ , both sides are empty because  $S'$  occurs on no right-hand side and the parser does not reduce  $[S' \rightarrow S\$]$ . This is (22). □

**Theorem 12** (Digraph computation of lookahead). *The least relations **Read**, **Follow** generated above compute every lookahead set by the formula (22).*

*Proof.* The Read and Follow fixed-point claims are Lemmas 9 and 10; applying them to the semantic definition of **LA** gives Corollary 11, which is the displayed formula of the theorem. □

### 3 Lookahead Restriction

Recall the lookahead set **LA** of (16). Replace the LR(0) reduction function by

$$\mathbf{reduce}_{\mathbf{LA}}(q, t) \triangleq \{[A \rightarrow \omega] \mid [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q, t \in \mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega])\}. \quad (23)$$

Let  $\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}$  be the transition relation obtained from  $\vdash$  by replacing **reduce** with **reduce**<sub>LA</sub>, and let  $L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}})$  be its accepted language.

**Lemma 13** (Guarded soundness).

$$L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}) \subseteq L(G).$$

*Proof.* From (23),

$$\mathbf{reduce}_{\mathbf{LA}}(q, t) \subseteq \mathbf{reduce}(q, t) \implies \vdash_{\mathbf{LA}} \sqsubseteq \vdash \implies \vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}^* \sqsubseteq \vdash^*.$$

Therefore

$$L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}) \subseteq L(\text{LRA}(G)) = L(G) \quad \text{by coro 8.} \quad (24)$$

□

**Lemma 14** (Guarded completeness).

$$L(G) \subseteq L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}).$$

*Proof.* Let  $z \in L(G)$ . In the completeness construction of corollary 8, every Reduce step has the form

$$(\alpha\omega : q_0 \rightarrow q, tz') \vdash (\alpha A : q_0 \rightarrow \delta(p, A), tz'),$$

where

$$S' \xRightarrow{\mathbf{rm}}_{P'} S\$ \xRightarrow{\mathbf{rm}}^*_{P'} \alpha A tz', \quad \alpha\omega : q_0 \rightarrow q, \quad [A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q.$$

By (16),

$$t \in \mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) \iff [A \rightarrow \omega] \in \mathbf{reduce}_{\mathbf{LA}}(q, t).$$

Thus every Reduce step used in that accepting LR(0) computation is also legal for  $\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}$ ; Shift steps are unchanged. Hence

$$L(G) \subseteq L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}).$$

□

**Corollary 15** (Language preservation).

$$L(\vdash_{\mathbf{LA}}) = L(G).$$

*Proof.* Combine Lemmas 13 and 14. □

**Lemma 16** (Conflict-free table condition). *If the resulting table has no shift/reduce or reduce/reduce conflict, its action is single-valued under one-symbol lookahead, hence it is an LALR(1) table.*

*Proof.* The action at  $(q, t)$  consists of the shift  $\delta(q, t)$  when it is nonempty and the reductions in  $\mathbf{reduce}_{\mathbf{LA}}(q, t)$ . Absence of shift/reduce and reduce/reduce conflicts means that this action is single-valued under one-symbol lookahead, which is precisely the LALR(1) table condition. □

**Theorem 17** (Lookahead-guarded reductions).

*If the resulting table has no shift/reduce or reduce/reduce conflict, it is an LALR(1) parser and accepts  $L(G)$ .*

*Proof.* Corollary 15 gives acceptance of  $L(G)$ , and Lemma 16 gives the LALR(1) table condition under the stated absence of conflicts. □

## A Digraph Algorithm and Implementation Specification

This appendix gives an executable specification for computing the sets used in Theorem 12. The construction is the usual digraph view of LALR(1) lookahead computation: direct seed sets are placed on nodes, dependency edges describe set inclusions, and the least fixed point is obtained by collapsing strongly connected components and propagating set unions along the resulting DAG [1, 2, 3].

### A.1 General Digraph Fixed-Point Problem

Let  $X$  be a finite set of nodes, let  $E \subseteq X \times X$  be a directed edge relation, and let  $\text{Seed} : X \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(T')$ . We use the edge orientation

$$x \rightsquigarrow y \quad \text{to mean} \quad F(y) \subseteq F(x).$$

Thus the desired solution is the least function  $F : X \rightarrow \mathcal{P}(T')$  satisfying

$$F(x) = \text{Seed}(x) \cup \bigcup_{x \rightsquigarrow y} F(y). \tag{25}$$

**Algorithm** DIGRAPH( $X, E, \text{Seed}$ ).

1. Compute the strongly connected components of  $(X, E)$ , for example by Tarjan's depth-first-search algorithm.
2. Build the condensation DAG  $\mathcal{C}$ . Its nodes are SCCs, and  $C \rightsquigarrow D$  is an edge when some  $x \in C$  and  $y \in D$  satisfy  $x \rightsquigarrow y$ , with  $C \neq D$ .

3. Initialize, for every SCC  $C$ ,

$$\text{Val}(C) \leftarrow \bigcup_{x \in C} \text{Seed}(x).$$

4. Process the SCCs in reverse topological order with respect to  $\rightsquigarrow$ , so every successor  $D$  of  $C$  has already been processed, and put

$$\text{Val}(C) \leftarrow \text{Val}(C) \cup \bigcup_{C \rightsquigarrow D} \text{Val}(D).$$

5. Return  $F(x) \triangleq \text{Val}(C_x)$ , where  $C_x$  is the SCC containing  $x$ .

**Correctness condition.** For every SCC  $C$ , after step 4,

$$\text{Val}(C) = \bigcup \{ \text{Seed}(y) \mid \text{some } x \in C \text{ reaches } y \text{ in } (X, E) \}.$$

Therefore the returned  $F$  is exactly the least solution of (25). This is the only property of the graph algorithm needed by Theorem 12.

**Complexity.** Let  $b = \lceil |T'|/w \rceil$ , where  $w$  is the machine word size used for bitsets. SCC construction is  $O(|X| + |E|)$ , and set propagation is

$$O((|X| + |E|)b).$$

A simple work-list implementation that repeatedly applies

$$F(x) := F(x) \cup F(y) \quad (x \rightsquigarrow y)$$

is also correct, but the SCC version avoids repeated propagation inside cycles.

## A.2 Instance for Read

First compute nullable nonterminals by the least fixed point

$$\text{Null}(A) \iff \exists [A \rightarrow X_1 \cdots X_k] \in P' \text{ such that every } X_i \text{ is nullable,}$$

where terminals are never nullable and  $k = 0$  is allowed. Extend this to strings by

$$\text{Null}(X_1 \cdots X_k) \iff \bigwedge_{i=1}^k \text{Null}(X_i).$$

For  $x = (p, A) \in D$ , define the direct-read seed

$$\text{DR}(p, A) \triangleq \{t \in T' \mid \delta(\delta(p, A), t) \neq \emptyset\}.$$

Define  $E_R \subseteq D \times D$  by

$$(p, A) \rightsquigarrow_R (r, C) \iff \delta(p, A) = r \wedge C \in N' \wedge \text{Null}(C) \wedge (r, C) \in D.$$

If  $(r, C) \notin D$ , then **Read**!  $(r, C) = \emptyset$ , so no edge is needed. Compute

$$\mathbf{Read}!(p, A) \triangleq \text{DIGRAPH}(D, E_R, \text{DR})(p, A).$$

## A.3 Instance for Follow

The seed for follow propagation is the already computed read set:

$$\text{Seed}_F(p, A) \triangleq \mathbf{Read}!(p, A).$$

Define  $E_I \subseteq D \times D$  by

$$(p, A) \rightsquigarrow_I (p', B) \iff [B \rightarrow \beta \cdot A\gamma] \in p \wedge \beta : p' \rightarrow p \wedge \text{Null}(\gamma) \wedge (p', B) \in D.$$

The orientation means

$$\mathbf{Follow}!(p', B) \subseteq \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A).$$

Compute

$$\mathbf{Follow}!(p, A) \triangleq \text{DIGRAPH}(D, E_I, \text{Seed}_F)(p, A).$$

## A.4 Lookback Relation and Lookahead Construction

For every completed item  $[A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q$ , define

$$\text{LB}(q, A \rightarrow \omega) \triangleq \{(p, A) \in D \mid \omega : p \rightarrow q\}.$$

Then

$$\mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega]) \triangleq \bigcup_{(p, A) \in \text{LB}(q, A \rightarrow \omega)} \mathbf{Follow}!(p, A),$$

which is (22) written as an implementation step.

**Implementation note.** The query  $\omega : p \rightarrow q$  can be implemented by following  $\delta$ -edges from  $p$  along  $\omega$ . The query  $\beta : p' \rightarrow p$  in  $E_I$  can be implemented by caching reverse-path queries keyed by  $(\beta, p)$ , or by storing predecessor edges during construction of the LR(0) automaton.

## A.5 Parser-Table and Conflict Specification

After  $\mathbf{LA}$  has been computed, construct actions as follows.

1. If  $\delta(q, t) \neq \emptyset$  for  $t \in T'$ , add the shift action

$$q \xrightarrow{t} \delta(q, t).$$

2. For each  $[A \rightarrow \omega \cdot \varepsilon] \in q$  and each  $t \in \mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega])$ , add the reduce action  $A \rightarrow \omega$  under lookahead  $t$ .
3. Report a shift/reduce conflict when both a shift action and a reduce action are present for the same pair  $(q, t)$ .
4. Report a reduce/reduce conflict when two distinct reduce productions are present for the same pair  $(q, t)$ .

The accepting condition remains the one in Definition 1: the parser accepts when it reaches

$$(S\$ : q_0 \rightarrow q_f, \varepsilon).$$

Equivalently, in a conventional ACTION/GOTO table,  $q_f$  may be treated as the accepting state after the input marker has been consumed.

## A.6 Summary Specification

The complete computation required by Theorem 12 is:

1. Build  $G'$ ,  $Q$ , and  $\delta$  as in Definition 1.
2. Compute nullable nonterminals and nullable strings.
3. Build  $D$ ,  $\text{DR}$ , and  $E_R$ ; compute **Read** by  $\text{DIGRAPH}(D, E_R, \text{DR})$ .
4. Build  $E_I$ ; compute **Follow** by  $\text{DIGRAPH}(D, E_I, \text{Read})$ .
5. Build  $\text{LB}$  and compute each  $\mathbf{LA}(q, [A \rightarrow \omega])$  by unioning the appropriate **Follow**-sets.
6. Construct the guarded reduce actions and check conflicts.

The postcondition is that the computed **Read**, **Follow**, and  $\mathbf{LA}$  are the least sets satisfying Theorem 12, and hence the lookahead-restricted parser of Theorem 17 uses exactly the LALR(1) lookahead sets determined by the LR(0) automaton.

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